

GLOSSARY



adaptation

When an animal or plant changes over time, helping it to survive in its habitat

agronomist

Scientist who studies harvesting and growing crops

astronomy

Study of the universe, including space, galaxies, and solar systems

atom

Smallest unit of an element. It contains protons, neutrons, and electrons

atomic number

Number of protons in an element's atom

bacteria

Tiny living things. Some bacteria can cause diseases

biology

Branch of science concerned with life and living things

characteristics

Features of something, such as the seed color of pea plants

chemistry

Branch of science concerned with substances and how they react with each other

climate

Weather patterns for a particular area over time

continent

Large area of land, such as Europe or Africa

decay

Process of radioactive atoms breaking apart

DNA

Chemical that genes are made of. Stands for deoxyribonucleic acid

element

Simplest substance, with one type of atom. There are more than 100 different elements and they include hydrogen, carbon, oxygen, and gold

epidemic

Large outbreak of a disease

evolution

Gradual changes in living things over a long period of time, so that they adapt to their environment

expedition

Trip taken to explore unknown lands

extinct

When a species of animal or plant has completely died out

fossil fuel

Fuel made from plants and animals that died millions of years ago. Fossil fuels include gas, oil, and coal

genes

Coded sections of DNA. They control the way living things work and develop

genetics

Study of genes

gravity

Invisible force of attraction between two objects, such as the pull between the Earth and the moon

habitat

Place where a species of animal or plant lives

hybrid

When two things are combined to make something new

laboratory

Room in which scientific experiments are performed. Often shortened to "lab"

magnetic

Used to describe magnets, which are objects that attract some substances, such as the metal iron, with an invisible force

